

This particular use of emulators will probably see many more new players in the developer market and they'll only get better as Mobile OSes become more sophisticated.

Why not just use the actual device?

It becomes possible to test the app or website on a wide variety of emulated devices which otherwise wouldn't have been possible considering the number of devices out there and how quickly they're replaced. You're only limited by the number of emulators you can find.

No mobile data charges are incurred as a standard web connection is used by the emulator.

Working on an emulator is also comparatively faster as app installation is quick and there's no need to switch between SIM cards or reboot devices.

Emulators are the next best thing to the actual device/browser and many emulators are available for free.

What are the issues in using mobile emulators?

Your website or app may work flawlessly on an emulator, but could show some issues on the real device. This might happen because the emulator differs in some minor ways from the actual device or there could be other variables involved. A few reasons for this are that the emulator developer might not be the device creator, or that the actual device suffered from issues such as overheating or component issues.

What are the types of mobile emulators?

- **Device emulators:** These are emulators for specific devices (or a set of devices) provided by the device manufacturers themselves. They're excellent for testing an app or a website with near-perfect results.
- **Browser emulators:** Mobile browser emulators display mobile versions of websites. They're good for testing websites with the mobile browser's functionality, but not the best for device specific testing.
- **Operating System (OS) emulators:** They simulate a mobile device environment in which other mobile apps can be accessed and tested.

Some popular desktop-based mobile emulators

Android Studio

If hardcore app development is your game, then you need the Android Studio from Google – a full-fledged IDE (Integrated Development Environment)